Past simple questions: what Murphy does not tell you

Day 2 · Grammar beyond Murphy

Murphy first
Murphy red, Unit 12 (pages 34–35): the form of questions. Do **12.2, 12.4** in class, **12.5** at home (12.3 is for the review week). Unit 45 (pages 100–101): **45.1** at home, **45.2** on Day 3.
This file adds five things the book does not explain.

1 · Question words: a quick map

What (thing) · **Where** (place) · **When** (time) · **Who** (person) · **Why** (reason) · **How** (way) · **How long** · **How many** · **What time** · **Which**

*Where **did** you go? How long **did** it take? What time **did** the film start?*

Order: question word + did + subject + base verb.

2 · No did with be and with who / what as the subject

be: *Where **were** you? How **was** the film?* (never Where did you were?)

Who / what is the subject: *Who **called** you? What **happened**?* (never Who did call?)

Compare: Who did you call? (the object) → did. Who called you? (the subject) → no did.

3 · The verb stays plain

*Did you **see** the film? Yes, I **saw** it.*

Only the answer has the past form; the question has the base form: ✗ ~~Did you saw~~ → ✓ Did you **see**.

4 · Answers: natural and short

Did you like it? → **Yes, I did.** / **No, I didn't.** / **A bit.** / **Not really.**

Where did you go? → **To the library.** (not a full sentence)

When did you finish? → **An hour ago.** / **At six.**

5 · The Russian trap

«Ты ходил в библиотеку?» has no helper word. English needs **did**: *Did you go to the library?*

And «Что случилось?» → *What happened?* (no did) — Russian speakers often add it by mistake: ✗ What did happen?

Practice

Day 2 · Practice 1

What to do: Exercises 1–2 in class, alone, then check. Exercise 3: the class translates aloud, one sentence each.

1 Make questions: put the words in order

1. (did / you / where / go) ____?
2. (the film / start / time / what / did) ____?
3. (you / did / the book / like) ____?
4. (how long / the lesson / was) ____?
5. (who / the report / did / write) ____?
6. (called / who / you) ____?
7. (why / he / late / was) ____?
8. (you / did / the library / when / visit) ____?

2 Choose the correct form

1. Where (you went / did you go) last weekend?
2. Who (saw / did see) the alien?
3. How (was / did be) the exam?
4. What (happened / did happen) at the party?
5. (Did he study / Did he studied) all night?
6. Who (did you meet / you met) at the library?

3 Translate into English

1. Где ты был вчера?

2. Что ты делал в библиотеке?

3. Кто написал этот доклад?

4. Ты видел это кино? — Да.

5. Сколько времени это заняло?

6. Что случилось?

7. Почему ты опоздал?

Practice 2

Day 2 · Practice 2

What to do: Alone, then read your sentences aloud.

4 Interview a partner about last weekend

Ask 6 questions with Did / Where / When / Who / What / How. Write the questions and the short answers.

5 Complete the dialogue

A: (1 Where) _____ you go yesterday?

B: I went to the planetarium.

A: (2 Who) _____ you go with?

B: With my class. A: (3 What) _____ you see?

B: A film about Mars. A: (4 Did) _____ you like it?

B: Yes, I (5 ____) _____. It was great. A: (6 How long) _____ the film last?

B: About forty minutes. A: (7 What time) _____ you get home?

B: At six. (8 Who) _____ called you in the evening? A: My friend Ali.

Answers · Day 2 grammar

For the teacher

1 Where did you go? · What time did the film start? · Did you like the book? · How long was the lesson? · Who wrote the report? · Who called you? · Why was he late? · When did you visit the library?

2 did you go · saw · was · happened · Did he study · did you meet

3 Where were you yesterday? · What did you do in the library? · Who wrote this report? · Did you see this film? — Yes, I did. · How long did it take? · What happened? · Why were you late?

4 Own answers: check the order (question word + did + subject + base verb).

5 did · Who did · What did · Did · did · How long did · What time did · Who (called)